ENGLISH B2 · EXERCISE WORKBOOK

Past ability and achievement

Printable practice for Past ability and achievement in English B2. No explanations or solutions interrupt the work pages.

THIS DOCUMENT

Exercise workbook

30 learning decisions arranged in six progressive stages. Write directly on the page and consult the separate answer key only after completing a stage.

RECOMMENDED USE

Keep the three-document system together

Use the complete guide to understand the concept, this workbook to practise, and the answer key to diagnose each decision.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a repeated or continuing ability in the past?

OPTIONS At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages. · Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files. · The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: success in one difficult past situation?

OPTIONS Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files. · The technician was unable to reproduce the fault. · At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: failure in a specific past attempt?

OPTIONS The technician was unable to reproduce the fault. · At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages. · Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a repeated or continuing ability in the past · success in one difficult past situation · failure in a specific past attempt

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS success in one difficult past situation · failure in a specific past attempt · a repeated or continuing ability in the past

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS failure in a specific past attempt · a repeated or continuing ability in the past · success in one difficult past situation

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: General ability / Specific achievement / Failed attempt · Gap 2: a repeated or continuing ability in the past / success in one difficult past situation / failure in a specific past attempt

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Specific achievement / Failed attempt / General ability · Gap 2: success in one difficult past situation / failure in a specific past attempt / a repeated or continuing ability in the past

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The technician was unable to reproduce the fault." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Failed attempt / General ability / Specific achievement · Gap 2: failure in a specific past attempt / a repeated or continuing ability in the past / success in one difficult past situation

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

03 · PRACTICE STAGE

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a repeated or continuing ability in the past: _____. Choose the model that expresses success in one difficult past situation: _____. Choose the model that expresses failure in a specific past attempt: _____. Choose the model built with could + base verb: _____. Choose the model built with managed to / was able to + base: _____. Choose the model built with could not / was unable to + base: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

At sixteen, Lena could speak three languages. · Despite the outage, the team managed to recover the files. · The technician was unable to reproduce the fault.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

At sixteen, Lena _____ three languages. Despite the outage, the team _____ the files. The technician _____ the fault. State the full structural pattern for General ability: _____. State the full structural pattern for Specific achievement: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “Speaking three languages was a general ability.” using the General ability pattern to express a repeated or continuing ability in the past.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The team succeeded in that particular recovery.” using the Specific achievement pattern to express success in one difficult past situation.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The attempt to reproduce the fault did not succeed.” using the Failed attempt pattern to express failure in a specific past attempt.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “Speaking three languages was a general ability.” using the General ability pattern to express a repeated or continuing ability in the past.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use General ability to express a repeated or continuing ability in the past, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Specific achievement to express success in one difficult past situation, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Failed attempt to express failure in a specific past attempt, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

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_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____